

## Credits

Written by Eddy Webb

*Pugmire* created by Eddy Webb and owned by Pugsteady

Edited by Maria Cambone

Art by Jeff Laubenstein, Bryan Syme, Chris Bivins, Pat Loboyko, Alida Saxon

Art direction by Michael Chaney and Rich Thomas



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# The Secret of Vinsens Tomb

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# Welcome to Pugmire!

Imagine our world, but far in the future. Countless centuries have gone by, and everything looks very different than it does now. Most buildings have crumbled to dust, and broken roads are buried deep beneath dense forests and layers of rocks. Here and there, the occasional ancient ruin or incomprehensible object surfaces, giving tantalizing glimpses of a world that once was. The work of mankind has been reclaimed by nature, but we're all gone. Humanity is no more. And those that remain — our best friends — start to reclaim our legacy.

That's *Pugmire*. It's a fantasy game with evolved dogs as the main characters. They live in the ruins of our world, using tools, language, and ingenuity to build a new civilization in their image. And the kingdom of *Pugmire* is a center of that civilization. Many of these dogs strive to learn about Man (also known as "the Old Ones"). They deify humanity as examples all should strive to emulate. Other nations, such as the cats in the

Monarchies of Mau, have different perspectives on what came before, but all species recognize there was a world before this one, even though it's now populated with mysteries and dangers.

As the dogs explore the world, they create and invent many new things, but also use what they can salvage. Some have even learned how to use the strange artifacts left behind by the Old Ones. They see these as literal gifts from their gods — rare and unusual magic relics, spells, and enchantments. We might dimly recognize them as the results of some far-flung futuristic invention, but any sufficiently-advanced technology is indistinguishable from magic.

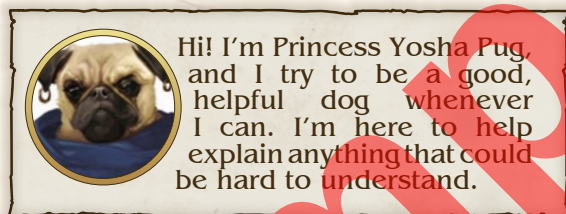
These heroic dogs, eager for mystery and danger, are the characters you portray. As you explore this world — a world that is and yet isn't the one we know — one question will follow your every decision: Are you a good dog?



# How do I get started?

This jumpstart has just about everything you need – rules, a short adventure, and some characters to get you started. You'll need to find some people to play the game with you. The person with the most experience playing tabletop roleplaying games should probably act as Guide, though if none of the group is experienced, the person who picked up this jumpstart or who is most familiar with the rules should give it a try. Each player will need a pencil, a sheet or two of scratch paper, and their character sheet. Players require dice, but they can share until everyone buys their own set. Typically, players will need a set of dice including one each of a 4-sided, 6-sided, 8-sided, 10-sided, and 12-sided, along with two 20-sided dice. The 20-sided dice – also called "d20" for short – will be used most often, so those are most important.

To help you out in reading this book, there are a few different kinds of text boxes (or *sidebars*, as we call them) to point you in the right direction or call attention to something important.



This is a section of text you read out loud to everyone at the table. Only the Guide sees these, to help her describe or explain something to her players.

## Defining Characters

The *Pugmire* characters (starting on p. 32) are detailed using a variety of statistics, attributes, and descriptions.

## Ability Scores

Every character, from the most heroic warrior to the lowliest cur, has six *abilities*. Even monsters and people from other species have abilities! Nearly every roll you make in *Pugmire* is based on one of these abilities, so they're important for everyone. Each ability has a *score* and a *modifier*. The scores generally range from 1-20, and modifiers range from -5 to +5.

**Strength:** The ability to apply physical force.

**Dexterity:** Physical coordination and agility.

**Constitution:** Overall hardiness and resistance to pain.

**Intelligence:** Mental skill and knowledge.

**Wisdom:** Wit and common sense.

**Charisma:** Personality and likability.

Each character has two of the abilities marked as *primary abilities*. These two abilities are the ones the character uses the most. They also allow the dog to use her proficiency bonus for saving throws (p. 7).

## Other Core Concepts

Every time a dog is hurt, he loses stamina. Once his stamina runs out, he is unconscious and possibly dying. In *Pugmire* you track how healthy your dog is through both *stamina points* and *stamina dice*.

Your dog's *defense* represents how well he avoids being wounded in battle. Without armor or a shield, your dog's defense equals 10 + his Dexterity modifier. Some spells and tricks give you a different way to calculate your dog's defense. If he has multiple tricks, spells, or items that impact his defense, you choose which one to use.

A dog's *initiative* determines how fast she acts at the start of a fight.

*Speed* is how far a dog can move during her turn. All dogs can move at a speed of 30 feet per turn. If they drop to all fours to run, they can increase their speed to 40 feet per turn.

*Skills* are things your dog can do well. Think of them as verbs – when your character is asked what she is good at, she might say "I can balance, notice things, perform, and I know about history." Skills are binary: you either have a skill or you don't.

*Tricks* are the special abilities and powers dogs get. Each of the ready-made-characters presented in this jumpstart have several tricks.

Every dog's personality is reflected through *personality traits*. By playing up your dog's personality traits, such as voluntarily failing a roll at appropriate times, you build up and spend the group's fortune (pp. 7-8).

Adventurous dogs are assumed to be well-equipped as they head out to explore. Everything they have on them is part of their *rucksack*. Each character has some starting equipment in her rucksack, listed on their character sheet.



**The dogs of Pugmire mine plastic (a mystical material left in the earth by Man) and mint it into currency. I'm lucky to get a few plastic coins from time to time, but Pugmire isn't a game about keeping a ledger of expenses. Your rucksack for your background tells you if your dog has a few, some, or many coins, which may be useful during your adventure. If you want to use money for anything, ask your Guide and she'll let you know if you have enough.**

## The Rules

The core rules of the game are simple. Most of the game takes the form of a conversation between the Guide and the players. The Guide describes the setting or the situation the characters are in, and the players respond with what their characters say or do in response. The Guide then gives new information, and the conversation continues, all the while creating a new *Pugmire* story.

The dice and the rules only come out when a character takes an action where the outcome is uncertain and interesting. When that happens, the player or the Guide takes the following steps in order:

- **Step 1.** Pick up a d20.
- **Step 2.** Determine if the character has an *advantage* or a *disadvantage*. If so, pick up another d20.

- **Step 3.** Roll the die or dice. If the character has an *advantage*, use the higher result. If the character has a *disadvantage*, use the lower roll. A higher number is generally better.
- **Step 4.** Add (or subtract) any relevant modifiers to the roll: usually an *ability modifier*, sometimes a *proficiency bonus*, and occasionally a bonus from a *trick*.
- **Step 5.** Compare the total to the *difficulty* of the task. If it equals or exceeds the difficulty number, the action is a success!

## Three Different Rolls

There are three distinct kinds of rolls in *Pugmire*.

### Ability Checks

*Ability checks* (or sometimes just "checks") are the most common form of dice roll. Whenever your dog attempts to accomplish something that isn't an attack, you roll a check based on her most relevant ability. For example, if your dog wants to try and climb a slippery wall, that's a Dexterity ability check.

### Attack Rolls

Whenever your dog wants to try and hurt another character, you need to make a different kind of roll called an *attack roll*. Even though an attack roll uses an ability, it's not the same thing as an ability check. If your dog wanted to shoot a rampaging giant ant with a bow, for example, you'd make a Dexterity attack roll, *not* a Dexterity ability check.

### Saving Throws

Sometimes, a dog isn't doing something so much as avoiding something. If the dog is trying to avoid damage, conditions (pp. 16-17), or just a bad effect, she makes a roll called a *saving throw*. Saving throws are distinct from both ability checks and attack rolls — needing to dodge away from a cloud of gas, for example, is a Dexterity saving throw, not an ability check or an attack roll.





Remember, these kinds of dice rolls are different, so make sure to read the rules carefully! If something gives you an advantage to all ability checks that use Dexterity, for example, that doesn't mean it gives you an advantage on checks using any other ability. It also doesn't apply to Dexterity-based attack rolls or Dexterity-based saving throws.

## Proficiency Bonus

The *proficiency bonus* represents your dog's growth in knowledge and experience. If your dog is skilled in something, you can add her proficiency bonus to appropriate die rolls:

- Attack rolls using weapons for which she has an appropriate Aptitude trick
- Attack rolls with spells she casts
- Ability checks using skills she has
- Saving throws, based on her calling's primary abilities
- Saving throw difficulties for spells she casts

Your dog's proficiency bonus can't be added more than once to a single die roll or to another number. However, the proficiency bonus might occasionally be modified (doubled or halved, for example) before you apply it.

## Results of d20 rolls

When rolling a d20 against a difficulty, there are four possible results.

**Failure:** If the total result of the roll after all modifiers is less than the difficulty, the action fails. In some cases, this might simply mean that nothing happens (such as failing to climb over a wall), but other times it might make things worse (such as failing to bribe a guard).

**Success:** If the total result of the roll after all modifiers is equal to or greater than the difficulty, the action succeeds. Usually this means that whatever the player declared happens (such as climbing over the wall), but sometimes the Guide interprets the results (such as bribing a guard, but she only gives

you three minutes before she will sound the alarm).

**Botch:** If the number on the d20 is a 1, regardless of modifiers, then the action fails in a particularly bad way, called a *botch* (or, sometimes, a "natural 1"). The result may be obvious (such as falling off a wall and losing stamina points), or the Guide may need to interpret the results (such as the guard refusing the bribe and drawing her sword to attack).

**Triumph:** If the number on the d20 is a 20, regardless of modifiers, then the action succeeds in a particularly good way, called a *triumph* (or, alternatively, a "natural 20"). The result may be obvious (such as climbing over a wall very quickly), or the Guide may need to interpret the results (such as a bribed guard deciding to quit her job and leave with the bribe money before she's discovered).

## Fortune and the Fortune Bowl

*Fortune* is a measure of enthusiasm, inspiration, and teamwork. As characters overcome obstacles, portray their characters in interesting ways, or otherwise contribute to interesting stories, they build up fortune in their *fortune bowl*. When things get tough or a particularly critical roll needs to succeed, the players use fortune to push the odds in their favor.

At the start of every adventure, the fortune bowl has two points in it. The Guide can put fortune in the bowl as players play to their personality traits in a way that makes the story more complicated or interesting. The Guide can also give out fortune at her discretion if a player at the table makes someone laugh, comes up with a good plan, or acts in a way that everyone agrees is a "good dog."

Further, a player can force the Guide to put fortune into the bowl by intentionally failing. If he's about to make a roll that one of his dog's personality traits would impact (such as "be nice to cats" when a diplomat from the Monarchies of Mau is trying to get secret information out of him), the player can choose to fail before he rolls any dice. If he chooses failure, the Guide adds a fortune to the bowl, and the result counts as if the player rolled a botch.

Whenever a character is in a tight spot, the player can ask the group if it's okay to use fortune from the bowl. If no one disagrees, he takes one fortune out of the bowl and gives it back to the Guide — it's gone. The fortunate player then re-



rolls any die (including a damage or stamina die), choosing the higher roll. This isn't the same as having an advantage — the player can choose to reroll either d20 on a roll with an advantage or a disadvantage, and pick whichever result works best for him. Whether the player succeeds or fails, though, the point of fortune is gone from the bowl.

There are other uses for fortune besides rerolling a die. Spellcasting characters can use a point of fortune to cast a spell even if they are out of spell slots. A character can spend a fortune to interrupt initiative and take their action immediately (p. 14). Also, some tricks require the expenditure of fortune. In each of these cases, the player must ask the group if it's okay, as with any other use of fortune.

If the Guide chooses, she can add fortune to the bowl once per scene on behalf of a non-player character. That character can use the fortune in the same ways as a player character (rerolling a die, casting a spell without spell slots, interrupting initiative, or activating a trick).

## Working Together

Sometimes, two or more dogs team up directly to attempt something. It can be a joint effort to knock down a locked door, solve an ancient puzzle, or convince a servant to let them into his master's house. The dog leading the effort, or the one with the highest ability modifier, can make an ability check with an advantage, reflecting the help provided by the other dogs. In combat, this requires the helping character to use the Help action (p. 12).

A dog can only provide help if the task is one that she could attempt alone — for example, no matter how well intentioned, a dog can't help with magical research if she doesn't have Know Arcana. Moreover, a dog can help only when two or more individuals working together would actually be productive — for example, if two dogs fell overboard from a ship, neither can help the other to swim better.

When several individuals are trying to accomplish something as a group (such as everyone





trying to sneak past a suit of possessed armor), the Guide might ask for a group ability check. Everyone in the group makes the requisite ability check. If at least half of the group succeeds, the whole group is considered to have succeeded at the check. Otherwise, the whole group fails.

## Time

Time in a *Pugmire* game doesn't always work the same for characters as it does for the players. When everyone's character is involved in a conversation, time generally flows as normal, but the Guide might suddenly jump to the following morning, or she might spend several minutes working out each moment in a tense conflict. As such, *Pugmire* uses six special units of time to help keep things clear.

## Action

The shortest unit of time is an *action*. Whenever a character does something, like asking a question, throwing a switch, or swinging a sword, that's generally an action. Complex tasks might be several actions put together. In general, if you make an ability check or attack roll for it, it's probably an action.

## Turn

When in the middle of combat, it's helpful to know who has taken an action and who hasn't. When a character has done everything she can in a reasonable span of time (generally around a few seconds), then she's taken her *turn*. Turns in *Pugmire* are a lot like turns in other games — when your turn is over, it's someone else's turn.

## Round

When everyone has taken a turn in combat, that's called a *round*. Sometimes particular characters can't take an action — usually they'll be able to act again after a round, or after a few rounds. Once a round is over, all active characters take another turn.

## Scene

A *scene* covers all the action within a particular place and time. This is more flexible than the previous definitions, but it's easy to get the hang of. Sitting at a tavern for a few hours sharing stories might be a scene, but so is spending

all day on the road traveling to a ruin. Whenever the general location changes (out of the tavern drinking area and up to bed) or the general timeframe changes (night falls as everyone stops on the road to camp), the previous scene ends and a new one begins.

## Session

The time from when you start playing a single game of *Pugmire* until you stop. When it's time for everyone to pack up their things, that means the session is over.

## Story

A collection of scenes that lead to some sort of conclusion is called a *story* or an *adventure*. A story can be as simple as “the heroes leave *Pugmire*, fight some monsters, and bring back an artifact of Man,” or could be as complex as “the heroes uncover a conspiracy inside *Pugmire*, seek out the villains, and bring them before the crown to stand trial for their crimes.” In general, a story lasts about one to three game sessions.

## Distance

Sometimes, how fast a character is or how far away she is from someone else is important. All distances in *Pugmire* are given in feet, but that doesn't mean you should worry about precise measurements. A lot of times the Guide will use distance and measurements to give everyone at the table a general idea of how long something is, or how far something can reach. In fact, you could even change three feet into one meter, if that's more comfortable.

Never feel constrained by the numbers. If one dog runs at 30 feet per turn and is being chased by another that runs at 40 feet per turn, the second dog is faster and will catch up unless the first dog does something else — that's all you need to know. If a hole is more than 50 feet deep, a 50-foot rope won't reach a dog trapped at the bottom. Only use measurements if they add something to the story — otherwise, just make a guess and move on.

## Equipment

Dogs are assumed to be adequately equipped, armed, and armored per their capabilities. At the beginning of each story, each character can pick one additional piece of mundane equipment, based on the





needs of the adventure and what's available based on the area they're in. If they want more equipment, each player can ask the Guide to switch one of her existing pieces of equipment for a second piece.

If the dog would have a piece of equipment that wasn't detailed ahead of time, the player can make a Wisdom saving throw, with a difficulty equivalent to how unlikely it is for the dog to have the item in question (default difficulty is 15). Success means the dog suddenly remembers that she packed the item, and the player adds it to her sheet.

The Guide can create circumstances where dogs are unarmed, unarmored, or do not have access to their usual equipment. In these cases, dogs regain the benefits of their equipment once they can recover it, or when they rest in an area where they could conceivably re-equip themselves, such as a town.

## Resting, Sleeping, and Healing

*Resting* is a period of downtime, at least one hour long, during which a dog does nothing more

strenuous than eating, drinking, reading, napping, and tending to wounds. At the end of a rest, a dog can spend one or more of her remaining stamina dice. For each stamina die spent in this way, the player rolls the die, adds the dog's Constitution modifier, and heals that many stamina points (or, if the dog prefers, spell slots). The player can decide to spend additional stamina dice after each roll, up to the number she has at her level.

*Sleeping* can be any extended period of downtime, at least eight hours long. Aside from sleeping, a dog can do light activity: talking, eating, reading, or standing watch for a couple of hours. Once the dog wakes up, she regains all lost stamina points, spell slots, and expended stamina dice.

Every time the party sleeps outdoors while traveling in the wilderness, each player makes a Constitution saving throw for her character at difficulty 10. If the roll fails, she regains her stamina dice and spell slots, but not her stamina points. The player can choose to expend her character's rations from her rucksack (if she has any) to reroll.



## Vision

Some spells, tricks, and relics can give a dog the ability to see in darkness. Some enemies can do this as well. There are two kinds of special vision: *Darkvision* and *Low-light Vision*.

**Darkvision:** Darkvision allows for a character to see without any light at all. Characters that use Darkvision in darkness can only see in black and white (they can't discern any colors). It doesn't give them any ability to see things they normally wouldn't be able to see in the light, such as invisible characters.

**Low-light Vision:** Low-light Vision allows a character to see twice as far as normal in dim light. They can see in color and discern detail as if the area were brightly lit. They do need to take a few seconds to adjust, however — a character with Low-light Vision who suddenly has bright light in their eyes may get the Blind condition (p. 16) for a few minutes.

## Traps and Ambushes

Sometimes, danger is hidden. The pit with spikes might be covered with a thin layer of leaves, or an enemy might lurk behind a thick curtain, waiting for the perfect moment to strike. However, requiring rolls to check every 10 feet of an ancient ruin can become tedious very quickly.

Instead of requiring players need to be constantly alert, assume that the characters are. Whenever a character stumbles across a trap or is led into an ambush, have them make a Wisdom saving throw. The difficulty depends on the quality of the subterfuge — an intricately-concealed panel containing an ancient flame trap might need a difficulty of 20, while a pair of bandits in shiny armor hiding in a pile of leaves by the side of the road might only require a difficulty of 5.

**Failure:** You are surprised. The trap activates, or you are unable to act in the first round of combat (p. 12).

**Success:** You notice the surprise and can act to avoid it. If the trap is sprung (such as by the actions of another character who failed his saving throw), you may be able to make another saving throw, such as a Dexterity saving throw, to avoid being hurt. In combat, you can act normally.

**Botch:** You are completely flatfooted. The trap might be particularly effective, or you might grant an advantage to your ambushers.

**Triumph:** You were expecting trouble. You have an advantage on avoiding the trap (if it activates) or on your first turn of combat.

## Getting Lost

No matter how good your senses are or what kind of vision you might have, one of the biggest hazards of exploration is getting lost. Following a road, trail, or obvious feature like a river or shoreline makes it hard to become lost, but when travelers head off cross-country, things become more difficult, particularly in cases of poor visibility or traveling in difficult terrain (such as a dense forest, a moor, or in the mountains).

If the conditions could lead to a group becoming lost, the Guide may require that the character leading the way make a Wisdom check a few times during each day of travel. The difficulty of the check depends on the terrain, the visibility conditions, and whether any of the characters has a map, but 15 is a good default difficulty.

If the roll fails, the group is lost. The Guide can randomly determine in which direction the party is actually moving — roll a d12 and use a clock face (with 12 as north) as an indication of which direction the group is now moving in. They will continue to move in that direction until they get some indication that they are lost, such as finding a landmark or moving into new terrain that isn't expected (for Guides, a short but flavorful description of the journey between rolls not only acts as a clue that the characters are lost, but also helps to alleviate what could be just a series of dice rolls). Once they realize they are lost, the leader can make another Wisdom check to reorient.

## Combat

Sometimes, dogs must fight. When they do, the game moves into *combat*, which requires a more structured system of determining what each character does. Use the following steps to manage what your character can do in combat — each step is explained below.



1. Determine surprise.
2. Establish positions.
3. Roll initiative and start the first round.
4. Each character takes a turn, and can do one of each of the following per turn:
  - Regain reaction, if necessary.
  - Move up to the character's maximum speed.
  - Take one action.
  - Take one free action.
  - Take one bonus action, if available.
5. Once a turn is over, choose who goes next.
6. Once everyone has taken a turn, a new round begins. The player of the final character to act in the last round chooses who starts the new round.

## Step 1. Determine Surprise

The Guide determines whether anyone involved in the combat is surprised. If a character has the potential to be surprised, the Guide may require that some characters involved make Wisdom saving throws against an opponent's Dexterity check or a set difficulty.

If a character is surprised, that character does not take a turn during the first round — treat them as if they have already acted.

## Step 2. Establish Positions

The Guide describes where all the dogs and other characters are located, including how far away the characters are from each other. The players can suggest what their characters might be doing, but in the end the Guide makes the final decision.

## Step 3. Roll Initiative

Now everyone needs to know who goes first. Every character (that isn't surprised) in the combat makes a Dexterity check, including all non-player characters. The character that rolls the highest gets to go first. If the highest roll is tied between two or more characters, compare their Dexterity scores — the highest score goes first. If there's still a tie, the Guide decides who goes first.

## Step 4. Take A Turn

Whether it's a character controlled by a player or the Guide, each participant in the battle takes a turn. On her turn, a character can do one of each of the following.

### Regain Reaction

Some effects allow the character to act during a reaction. This is usually after the character has taken her turn, but before she takes her next turn. Opportunity attacks, Ready actions, tricks, and spell effects are all examples of things that may take place during a reaction. However, each character only has one reaction until her next turn. Some tricks or other actions call for a reaction from a character before it succeeds. If that character has already used her reaction, the thing in question automatically succeeds.

During step four, if the character has spent her reaction, she regains it at the start of her turn.

### Move

Move any distance up to the character's maximum speed. Movement can be broken up between other actions, if the total movement for the turn does not exceed the character's speed. Characters can also use their move to stand up if rendered Prone (p. 17).

### Take One Action

An action is one significant thing the character is doing on their turn, usually involving an ability check. The action can take place before, during, or after moving. Some possible actions that a character can take include:

- **Attack:** Attempt to damage an enemy (see "Attack Rolls," p. 14).
- **Cast:** Use a spell with a casting time of "one action," or add time to a spell with a longer casting time.
- **Change:** Replace one item in your paw(s) with one in your rucksack.
- **Defend:** Defend yourself more effectively. All attacks against you are at a disadvantage until your next turn, and you make Dexterity saving throws at an advantage.
- **Disengage:** Movement after taking this action doesn't provoke an attack of opportunity (p. 14).
- **Help:** Give a nearby (within 20 feet) ally





an advantage on an attack roll or ability check before your next turn.

- **Hide:** Make a Dexterity check (using the Sneak skill) to be or remain unseen.
- **Ready:** Decide on a triggering event (such as, “Once that cat gets within five feet of me...”). Then, decide on an action (such as, “... I will use my action to attack.”) If the trigger happens, you can spend your reaction to take the proscribed action, or ignore it and let the trigger expire. Artisans and shepherds can ready a spell with the casting time of one action in this way as well.
- **Run:** Move again up to your speed — in effect, you are moving twice.
- **Search:** Look through a nearby area (usually a Wisdom check).
- **Use:** Use an item or object.

### Take One Free Action

A free action is something your dog does that is quick and not significant — i.e., it does not require any checks or rolls. Examples of quick ac-

tions are:

- Ask or answer a question
- Banter
- Flip a switch
- Open an unlocked door
- Press a button
- Scream something

### Take One Bonus Action

Sometimes, a character will have a trick, a spell, or some other ability that allows them to do something using a *bonus action*. This is just like an action, but it allows you to do a second, specific thing during a turn. If a character has multiple opportunities to take a bonus action, however, only one can be used per turn. Something that requires a bonus action cannot be taken as a normal action, a free action, or a reaction.

### Step 5. Choose Who Goes Next

Once a character has taken her turn, the player or Guide who controls her can decide which



character goes next. Sometimes it's best to pick someone on your side, but occasionally it can be advantageous to pick someone on the opposite side. A character who is surprised or has already taken a turn this round cannot be chosen. The chosen character then goes to step four.

There is one exception: Once the next character is chosen, a player whose character hasn't gone can decide to *interrupt* the order. They spend a fortune from the bowl (as always, subject to group approval) and that player immediately goes to step four. Then they get to choose who goes next in step five, as if they were originally selected. Similarly, a character can choose the Ready action earlier in the round, and if a character performs the appropriate triggering action, the Ready character can interrupt for free!

The Guide can also interrupt, if they have non-player characters who haven't taken a turn. If the Guide chooses to interrupt, she adds a fortune to the fortune bowl, and then her chosen non-player character goes to step four, as if that character was selected. Non-player characters can also take the Ready action as well.

Once either a player or a Guide has spent fortune to interrupt the order, however, that's it until the turn is over. No one else can spend fortune to interrupt the interrupt. Only a previously-announced Ready action can interrupt, if the trigger condition is met.



When things are getting dangerous, it's sometimes hard to keep track of who has taken a turn. I once got so excited that I accidentally took my turn twice! An easy way to keep track of who has gone and who is yet to go is to use playing cards. Everyone gets one card, face up, and the Guide gets a card for each enemy or group of enemies. Once you've taken your turn, flip the card over so the back is showing. If everyone's card is face down, it's time to start a new round!

player or Guide of the character that went last in the previous round chooses which character goes first in the new round. She can choose her own character to go again, if she wishes.

## Attack Rolls

Whenever one character attacks another, the player or Guide makes an *attack roll* to see if she hits or misses. To make an attack, roll a d20 and add any appropriate modifiers (such as a proficiency bonus, and the Strength modifier if it's a melee attack or the Dexterity modifier if it's ranged). If the total of the roll plus modifiers equals or exceeds the target's defense, the attack hits and does damage.

**Failure:** Your attack misses.

**Success:** Roll the appropriate damage dice, add in all modifiers (such as the Strength or Dexterity modifier, but not the proficiency bonus), modify the results if needed (such as if a character is resistant or weak to that damage type), and subtract the total from the target's stamina points.

**Botch:** The attack misses regardless of any modifiers or the target's defense. In addition, the Guide might give the attacker a disadvantage or her opponents an advantage on a future roll.

**Triumph:** The attack hits regardless of the target's defense. Double the number of the attack's damage dice, roll them, and add them all together before adding any relevant damage modifiers as normal.

## Attack of Opportunity

Characters can make an *attack of opportunity* when a visible hostile character moves away from the attacker without disengaging first. The attacker can use his reaction to make a melee attack against the provoking character — think of it as a quick slash at the character's back before the moving character continues their turn.

If something or someone moves a character without them using a movement, action, bonus action, or reaction, then they don't provoke an attack of opportunity.

## Cover

A target with some cover has a +2 bonus to defense and an advantage on relevant saving throws. A target with total cover can't be targeted

## Step 6. Begin the Next Round

Once everyone who can take a turn this round has done so, a new round begins. The